

Lab 2.3: Finalize a Battle Card with Trap Questions

Introduction

This hands-on lab brings your competitive work together. You will take the ADP competitor profile you built in lab 2.2 and distill it into a field-ready battle card, adding at least three trap questions and clear differentiation statements. The goal is a one-page tool that a salesperson could glance at before going head-to-head with this competitor.

Learning Objectives

After completing this lab, you will be able to:

- Distill a competitor profile into a concise battle card.
- Write trap questions that fairly expose a competitor's weaknesses.
- State a clear differentiation that a seller can use in the field.



Scenario

You are continuing your competitive work at PayPro Solutions. In lab 2.2, you profiled ADP. Now leadership wants a battle card the sales team can use when competing against ADP in the mid-market, with a particular focus on two areas where PayPro believes it can differentiate: pricing transparency and customer service.

Your task is to turn your ADP profile into a one-page battle card that includes at least three trap questions. Use only fair and public-based positioning, the same ethical standard as the rest of this module.

Tools Overview

Battle Card Template:

The downloadable template from this lesson includes sections for quick positioning, their strengths, your counters, your differentiators, trap questions, and watch-outs.

Battle Card and Profile Inputs:

Your completed lab 2.2 ADP profile (or the lab 2.2 Exemplar Solution).

Resource Files

Battle Card Template (DOCX)
Lab 2.2 Exemplar Solution (DOCX)
Lab 2.3 Exemplar Solution (DOCX)

Step-by-Step Instructions

Exercise 1: Distill the Profile into Positioning and Differentiators

Objective: Turn your full profile into a concise and field-ready core.

Step 1: Write your one-line positioning

In a single sentence, state how PayPro positions against ADP in the mid-market.

Step 2: List your key differentiators

List three or four clear differentiators, and for each, note why it matters to a mid-market buyer.

Exercise 2: Write at Least Three Trap Questions

Objective: Create fair questions that surface ADP's weaknesses and PayPro's strengths.

Step 1: Focus on the two target areas

Write trap questions focused on pricing transparency and customer service, the two areas of differentiation. Each should be a neutral question that the buyer could ask any provider.

Step 2: Map each question

For each trap question, note which competitor weakness it targets and which PayPro strength it reinforces. If the honest answer would not favor PayPro, revise the question.

Exercise 3: Add Counters and Watch-Outs

Objective: Make the card honest and field-ready.

Step 1: Focus on the two target areas

Write trap questions focused on pricing transparency and customer service, the two areas of differentiation. Each should be a neutral question that the buyer could ask any provider.

Step 2: Map each question

For each trap question, note which competitor weakness it targets and which PayPro strength it reinforces. If the honest answer would not favor PayPro, revise the question.

Exercise 3: Add Counters and Watch-Outs

Objective: Make the card honest and field-ready.

Step 1: Add counters to their strengths

For ADP's main strengths, write a brief counter for each.

Step 2: Note the watch-outs

Note where ADP may genuinely win, so a seller is not caught off guard.

Self-Assessment Checklist

By the end of this lab, you should have a completed one-page battle card that includes:

- A one-line positioning statement and three to four differentiators.

- At least three trap questions, each mapped to a weakness and strength.

- Fair counters to ADP's strengths and an honest watch-out.

Summary

Congratulations! You have built a complete competitive battle card, the kind of tool that lets a seller position with confidence in a live deal. Notice that the strongest battle card never attacks the competitor; it equips the buyer to evaluate fairly, which is exactly when a well-matched solution wins.
